

CAREER PATHS

"Biotechnologist" is a broad term that encompasses many roles, from high-level research to manufacturing. To work in research, you will need a relevant degree. After specializing in one field, you may find it difficult to move into another.

TECHNICIAN You may be able to begin as a trainee laboratory technician while studying for a degree or industry qualification.

GRADUATE A degree in biology, chemistry, plant sciences, or biochemistry is required if you want to become a biotechnologist.



BIOTECHNOLOGIST
There are various opportunities to specialize, but each of these strands of biotechnology require further study.



BIOPHARMACEUTICAL ANALYST

Applies advanced techniques, such as genetic engineering, to develop new drugs used for treating diseases, such as arthritis and high blood pressure.



CLINICAL SCIENTIST

Works in a hospital carrying out clinical studies and analyzing data to develop new therapies, or providing diagnoses for medical staff.



BREWING BIOTECHNOLOGIST

One example of a specific foods application. Discovers methods of brewing and storing fermented products.



FUELS AND CHEMICALS BIOTECHNOLOGIST

Conducts research into the manufacture of cleaner fuels, such as bioethanol, or novel materials, such as biodegradable plastics, which are far more eco-friendly than many of the current products in use.

SKILLS GUIDE



Innovation and a willingness to learn new technologies as they emerge.



Logical and analytical approach to performing experiments and conducting research.



Problem-solving skills and the ability to formulate ideas, plan experiments, and interpret results.



Good computer skills to record and analyze experimental and product data.



The perseverance and motivation to rethink and restart experiments that may not work.



The ability to handle scientific equipment and take measurements very carefully.